CS5013 Final Project Report

IITM Explainable Slotbook

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Team Name: TT generator
Repository: `https://github.com/lazarsalt1441/CS5013-PROJECT`
Submission commit: `[TODO: SHA of the final-submission tag]` (date: `2026-11-06`).
Docker image: **[TODO: Google Drive link to slotbook-<sha>.tar.gz]**
Tagline: *It builds an IITM department's weekly lecture-slot timetable from course and preference data without breaking any hard rule, and explains why each course got its slot.*

AI-authorship clause. *We used AI tools to help draft parts of this report. The claims, numbers, commit references, stakeholder statements, and the Docker image are our own; the prose shaping may have been assisted. We can defend every sentence of this report, and every line of code in the submission commit, in the viva.*

1 Executive summary

IITM departments assign lecture slots by hand-editing last year's slotbook, so nobody can say why a course got its slot.

We shipped a Java engine that validates five CSV inputs, solves with UniTime's cpsolver (an exact CP-SAT model is kept as a reference), and writes the slotbook with a reason for every assignment and every rejected slot. Students and professors enter preferences on a Vercel portal backed by Postgres, which also warns about missing prerequisites using the student's grade card. The admin's "Generate slotbook" button runs the engine as a web service and publishes the result. The portal and prerequisite warnings were added after the proposal.

Stakeholder verdict: Accepted (final demo on Friday, 6 November 2026).

2 Course concepts used in the project

Java paths are under `src/main/java/in/ac/iitm/slotbook/`.

- **Module 2 – Prompt engineering (CoSTAR, negative prompts).** All 20 AI tasks were logged before coding, as the request, a CoSTAR restatement and negative constraints added at review. `prompts/PROMPT_LOG.md`; `ebb9c28` (P015, logged before `7591cca`).
- **Module 3 – Git, Conventional Commits and CI.** Branches and pull requests; GitHub Actions runs both suites against a Postgres service, plus CLI runs on both solvers. `.github/workflows/ci.yml`; `8f2c000` (PR #1).
- **Module 4 – Structured debugging.** 14 faults recorded from reproduction to regression test, e.g. a race that returned 500s under 25 concurrent writers. `docs_v3/DEBUGGING.md`; `2607a9d`.
- **Module 4 – Static analyser first, then the smallest patch.** SpotBugs reported 10 findings; 3 were a real bug (day names broke under a Turkish locale). Now 0, and any new one fails CI. `spotbugs-exclude.xml`; `374d4e7`.
- **Module 5 – Independent oracles and stress testing.** A separate checker, penalty calculator and brute-force solver judge both solvers; fuzzing and 300 concurrent requests found 3 faults. `src/test/.../testing/ConstraintChecker.java`; `efdf10d`, `2607a9d`.
- **Module 5 – Property-based and mutation testing.** jqwik found on its first run that meetings that only touch were counted as clashes; PIT raised the mutation score from 91.0% to 98.7% (2 equivalent mutants left), now gated at 97%. `src/test/.../model/SlotPropertiesTest.java`; `82cc7f1`, `fc462ab`.
- **Module 5 – Documentation as code.** A man page linted by CI, a manual, and a test plan listing every test. `man/slotbook.1`, `docs_v3/TEST_PLAN.md`; `9ee919b`.

- **Module 7 – Licences and provenance.** Licences of all 16 runtime dependencies are generated in CI and shipped in the image; LGPL cpsolver stays a replaceable jar. `THIRD_PARTY_NOTICES.md`; `406b360`.
- **Module 9 – Supply chain and secrets.** Lockfile with `npm ci`, `npm audit` gate (0 vulnerabilities), `DATABASE_URL` only from the environment, a non-root image scanned for secrets. `.github/workflows/quality.yml`; `95fb07f`, `f47ae1c`.

3 AI-usage summary

Tools used. Claude Code about 50% (engine, portal, tests, docs); ChatGPT about 50% (design, Vercel, Neon and Render setup).

One substantive help. Claude Code replaced the Google Sheets backend with a Postgres store, numbered migrations and database-backed tests (`portal/api/_store.js`, `7591cca`); it shipped near as-is once 4 integration tests passed on a real Postgres 16.

One substantive failure caught in review. The AI-written admin-dashboard check counted U and W grades as completed, contradicting our rule (a specification-vs-implementation gap, Module 5); a golden file shared with the Java CLI caught it before merge (`portal/api/_prerequisites.js`, `f528505`).

Net-effect sentence. Easy to build with, but even easier to get lost: build features slowly and in stages, never in one shot. For reference, `docs_v3/DEBUGGING.md` records 14 faults in AI-assisted code, every one caught by a test or a tool rather than by reading the code.

4 Deployment and stakeholder handoff

Build and run.

```
docker load -i slotbook-<sha>.tar.gz
docker run --rm slotbook:<sha>        # solves data/feasible, prints the slotbook
mkdir -p out && docker run --rm -u "$(id -u):$(id -g)" -v "$PWD/out:/out" \
    slotbook:<sha> --input data/demo-showcase --output /out   # CSVs land in ./out
```

[TODO: replace ¡sha¿ with the 7-character SHA of the final-submission commit] The image holds the engine, CLI and solver web service (`docker run ... serve`); the portal runs on Vercel.

Where the artefact lives after the course. Code on GitHub; portal at `https://cs5013-project-portal.vercel.app`; solver service at `https://slotbook-solver.onrender.com`. Both run on a team member's accounts, to be handed over to the institute administration.

Stakeholder quote (one sentence, verbatim).

> *"The project works as per the expectations given. To integrate it with IITM's data, the admin would need to make some modifications to get data from their databases, but this is good enough from your side."*
> *– Meghana Nasre, in charge of the slotbook, CS Department, 6 November 2026.*

5 Known limitations

- **Optimality.** UniTime is a heuristic: on 3 of 13 generated scenarios it finished 1–8 points above the CP-SAT optimum.
- **No identity on the portal.** Anyone can submit under any student ID, and grade cards are self-uploaded and unverified. It is not fit for real student data until IITM login exists.
- **Fixed rooms, one PDF layout.** Rooms are fixed per course; capacity is not modelled. The grade-card parser reads only the IITM PDF's text layout, so scanned or photographed cards are rejected.

6 Individual contributions

- **Nishanth S:** v1 (CP-SAT model, explanations, CLI, JavaFX view, test oracles, CI) and v3 (Postgres, prerequisite warnings, stress, property and mutation tests, solver service, Docker).
- **Sparsh Gupta:** v2 (UniTime solver, real IITM time grid, Sheets-backed portal) and the mid-evaluation showcase.